BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Sunday 18 Oct 2026, 15:50 Malaysia time (07:50 UTC)

BTC ~ $81,560

Coinbase, 18 Oct: 24h flat (-0.03%), 7d -1.7%

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral, slight bearish lean	**Next 24h:** $80,300 - $82,700	**Key floor:** $80,000 (then $79,000 max pain)	**Big event:** US open Mon (21:30 MYT) after 'Black Monday' weekend chatter

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

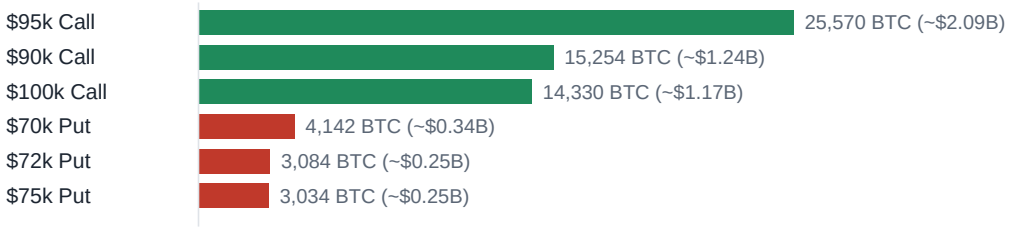
- Today's daily (18 Oct) expires at **16:00 MYT**, minutes after this report; the next one is the **Mon 19 Oct daily at 16:00 MYT**. Weekend dailies are usually small (a few thousand BTC at most) - no published size was found.
- The **Fri 23 Oct weekly** holds about 13,800-14,800 contracts (~$1.1-1.2B), put-heavy at a P/C of 1.24. It matters only if price is near a large strike late in the week.
- The expiry that matters is the **Fri 30 Oct monthly**: ~149,700 BTC (~$12.2B), about 35% of Deribit BTC options OI, two days after the 28 Oct FOMC decision.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
19 Oct daily (Mon 16:00)	n/a - not published	Small (est.)	Too small to steer spot; weekend dailies rarely pin price
23 Oct weekly - calls	6,149 calls total	~$0.50B	Fewer calls than puts; little upside dealer pressure this week
23 Oct weekly - puts	7,624 puts total	~$0.62B	Hedging bias; puts near $78k-80k would add support/pressure if tested
30 Oct monthly - call	$95,000 call	25,570 BTC (~$2.09B)	Largest single Deribit position; far out of the money (+16%)
30 Oct monthly - put	$70,000 put	4,142 BTC (~$0.34B)	Tail hedge; far below spot

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Mon 19 Oct, 16:00 (daily)	small, n/a	n/a	n/a	No published data this run
Fri 23 Oct, 16:00 (weekly)	~$1.2B (14,759 contracts)	1.24	n/a	Strike detail not published
Fri 30 Oct, 16:00 (monthly)	~$12.2B (149,686 BTC)	0.52	$79,000 (Deribit; Binance/OKX ~$81-82k)	Calls $95k 25,570 / $90k 15,254 / $100k 14,330; Puts $70k 4,142 / $72k 3,084 / $75k 3,034
Fri 25 Dec, 16:00 (quarterly)	n/a	n/a	~$75,000 (Deribit, 10 Oct)	n/a

30 Oct monthly - largest open interest by strike (BTC; USD at $81,560)



How options affect the market now

- **Next 24h expiry is too small to matter.** The Monday daily will not pin price; spot will be driven by the US equity open and ETF flows.
- **The big call walls ($90k-$100k) are far away.** About 55,000 BTC of calls sit 10-23% above spot, so dealer hedging there has no effect today. They only become a magnet/accelerator if BTC reclaims $86k-87k.

- **Max pain at $79,000 sits ~3% below spot** for the 30 Oct monthly. Into late October the pull is mildly lower, but that pull usually only shows in the last 2-3 days before expiry.
- **Sentiment split by tenor:** the monthly is call-heavy (P/C 0.52, long-dated upside bets), while the weekly is put-heavy (P/C 1.24) - near-term traders are paying for protection.
- **Implied vol ~32% (30 Oct tenor)** prices a ~1.7% daily move (~$1,380) and ~6% to 30 Oct ($76.5k-$86.3k). Vol is cheap relative to a hot-CPI, possible-Fed-hike backdrop - room for a vol pop if $80k breaks.
- If $80k gives way, put hedgers at $78k-$80k (weekly) and dealers short those puts would sell into weakness, which can speed up a drop toward $78k.

Data note: the Deribit public API (index, DVOL, book summary) could not be reached this run, so option figures come from published reports (CryptoTicker 17 Oct, TokenPost 16 Oct, Bitcoin.com 10 Oct) and are 'largest seen'. USD sizes = BTC OI x $81,560. IV is the 30 Oct implied vol quoted on 17 Oct, used in place of DVOL.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC has been stuck in an **$80,000-$82,000 box** all week after the 14 Oct hot CPI knocked it from ~$83,300 to below $81,500; it sits near the 50-day average (~$81,300).
- Overnight range $80,655-$81,961 on thin weekend volume (Kraken ~657 BTC/24h); 24h change is flat and the week is down ~1.7%.
- A weekend flash dip (18 Oct, ~05:30 UTC) took BTC down ~$1,000 and back up ~$1,200 in minutes, alongside AI/chip stock perpetuals falling up to 5% - a sign of jittery, thin liquidity.
- Momentum is soft: 4H RSI ~44 and MACD slightly negative (17 Oct). The 20-day average (~$84,000) caps rallies; the 200-day is far below at ~$72,400.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,000 - $84,250	20-day average and reclaim level analysts cite to reopen $87k
Resistance 1	$82,000	Top of the weekly box and overnight high ($81,961); 4H close above targets $83.5k-84k
Pivot	$81,300	50-day average and post-CPI support (Bitget); price is pinned around it
Support 1	$80,000 - $80,650	Round number, box floor and overnight low; October low $79,676 just under
Support 2	$78,000 - $79,000	30 Oct max pain ($79k) and next support named by several analysts ($78k)
Deep risk	$75,000 - $76,500	Lower edge of the options-implied range to 30 Oct and a put cluster; 200-day far below at ~$72.4k

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures OI (major venues, snapshot)	$7.68B, -0.7% 24h (17 Oct)	Leverage drifting lower; no build-up
Total BTC futures OI (all venues)	$51.7B (10 Oct)	Older figure; context only
Funding rate	+0.0035%/8h (~3.8% ann.) (17 Oct)	Mildly positive, cooler than the 0.01% norm - longs not crowded
Long/short accounts	63% / 37% (17 Oct)	Retail still leans long - fuel for long squeezes
Liquidations 24h	$222M total, BTC $43.5M, 72% longs (17 Oct)	Down from $973M on 15 Oct; weekend flash dip added small extra
Spot BTC ETF flows	16 Oct -$82.4M; 15 Oct +$5.1M; 14 Oct -$261.4M	Net outflows; October net negative (>$530M out by 14 Oct)
Fear & Greed	49 Neutral (17 Oct), from 57 a week ago	Sentiment cooling but not fearful
Implied vol	~32% (30 Oct tenor)	Implied daily move ~1.7% (~$1,380)

4. News and macro

- **Hot US CPI (released 14 Oct):** September headline 3.7% y/y vs 3.6% expected, core +0.3% m/m. Odds of a 25bp Fed **hike** on 28 Oct jumped to ~44-49% (CME) and ~55% (Kalshi); the range is 3.75-4.00% after a September hike.
- **Risk-off in stocks:** last week the S&P 500 fell ~2%, Nasdaq 100 and Nikkei ~5%, KOSPI ~14%. 'Black Monday' calls surged over the weekend ahead of the 19 Oct anniversary.
- **Geopolitics:** an IRGC-attributed claim that the Strait of Hormuz was closed was disputed by US CENTCOM (~400 vessels transited last week). A Ukrainian strike on the St. Petersburg oil port added oil-supply risk - both feed the inflation worry.
- **ETF demand weak:** spot BTC ETFs saw $82.4M of outflows on 16 Oct (IBIT -$71.8M); cumulative net inflows $56.88B.
- **Quantum headlines:** stories on Google's Willow progress and a 'Quantum Alliance' warning about ~6.4M exposed BTC weigh on narrative, though no immediate market impact.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Mon 19 Oct, 06:00	CME BTC futures reopen (watch weekend gap vs ~$81.5k)
Mon 19 Oct, 16:00	Deribit daily options expiry
Mon 19 Oct, 21:30	US stock open on Black Monday anniversary; ETF flows resume
Tue 20 Oct, 20:30	US housing starts / building permits (Sep)
Thu 22 Oct, 20:30	US initial jobless claims
Fri 23 Oct, 16:00	Deribit weekly options expiry (~$1.2B)
Fri 23 Oct, 21:45 / 22:00	S&P Global flash PMIs / UMich final sentiment and inflation expectations
Thu 29 Oct, 02:00	FOMC decision (27-28 Oct meeting) - hike risk ~45-55%
Thu 29 Oct, 20:30	US September PCE inflation
Fri 30 Oct, 16:00	Deribit monthly options expiry (~$12.2B, max pain $79k)
Tue 10 Nov, 21:30	US October CPI

5. Summary and prediction

BTC is coiled in an $80k-$82k box with flat 24h change, cooling leverage and mildly positive funding. Options are not a driver over the next day: the Monday daily is small and the large call walls ($90k-$100k) are far above. The bigger forces are macro - a hot CPI has put a Fed hike on the table for 28 Oct, equities are risk-off, and ETF flows are negative - while the 30 Oct max pain at $79k sits slightly below. The weekend flash dip shows liquidity is thin, so the US open on Monday night (MYT) is the likely catalyst. Momentum leans slightly negative, but funding is not crowded, so a squeeze either way is possible. **24h call: range $80,300-$82,700 with a slight downside lean; a 4H close below $80,000 opens $78k-79k.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range holds	55%	$80,300 - $82,700	Quiet Asia session, stocks stabilise at US open, ETF flows near flat
Bullish break	20%	$82,000 - $84,300	4H close above $82,000 plus equity relief / ETF inflows; shorts squeezed toward 20-day ($84k)
Bearish break	25%	$78,000 - $80,300	4H close below $80,000, equity sell-off on Black Monday chatter or Hormuz/oil headlines; long liquidations

- Breakout signals: a 4H close above $82,000 (bullish) or below $80,000 (bearish); CME gap at Monday 06:00 MYT.
- US stocks and VIX at the 21:30 MYT open, Monday ETF flow print, and any Fed-speaker comments on a hike.
- Next report: Sun 18 Oct, 23:50 MYT

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